

MICHIGAN ENVIRONMENTAL PROTECTION

REPORT

NORTHERNAIRE PLATING
CADILLAC, MICHIGAN
PROGRESS REPORT #4
July 23, 1985

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The Michigan Department of Natural Resources (DNR), with support from the U.S. Environmental Protection Agency (EPA), has initiated efforts under the federal Superfund program to resolve environmental contamination problems associated with the Northernnaire Plating Company in Cadillac, Michigan. This report is the fourth in a series to be issued periodically by the DNR to ensure that area residents are kept informed of progress made and future plans.

Public Meeting Planned

A public meeting has been scheduled for July 30, 1985, at 7:00 p.m. in the Cadillac Municipal Complex Council Chambers to discuss and accept public comments on alternatives for remedying soil and sewer-line contamination at Northernnaire Plating. Copies of the Feasibility Study describing the alternatives are available for review at the Cadillac Wexford Library and at the Service Desk of the Municipal Complex. The public comment period for this study will be from July 22 to August 12, 1985. This public comment period provides local citizens with an opportunity to express their opinions and concerns on the Feasibility Study and the alternatives for remedial action.

Public comment can be addressed to: John Perrecone, U.S. EPA, Region V, Office of Public Affairs, 230 South Dearborn Street, Chicago, Illinois 60604, telephone (800) 621-8431 (9:30 -5:30 EDT).

Project Update

E.C. Jordan Company, along with its subcontractors, has completed the initial phase of a Remedial Investigation at the Northernnaire Plating site. This investigation included monitor well installation, sampling of soil, sewer sediment and groundwater, and a geophysical survey. It was found that elevated levels of metals, principally cadmium and chromium, remain in soils and sewer lines at the site. Concentrations of cadmium and chromium in some



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of the soil and sewer sediments present a potential hazard because of possible continued leaching into groundwater aquifers and bioaccumulation through the food chain. The hazardous soils were primarily in small areas along the west side of the former Northernair facility building.

The Feasibility Study was conducted to evaluate the options for controlling soil and sewer-line contamination and the residual contamination of the building and underlying soils. This study evaluated the cost-effectiveness, reliability, constructability, and environmental impact of the various options.

The study describes five feasible alternatives for remedying soil and sewer-line contamination and four alternatives for remedying building and underlying soil contamination.

The alternatives for control of soil and sewer sediments include:

1. No Action.
2. Capping of site with impermeable clay.
3. Excavation of contaminated soils and sewer sediments and disposal in an on-site licensed facility.
4. Excavation of contaminated soils and sewer sediments and disposal in an off-site licensed facility.
5. Excavation of contaminated soils and sewer sediments, treatment using solidification/fixation technologies, and disposal in a licensed on-site facility.

The alternatives for addressing the residual building and underlying soil contamination include:

1. No Action.
2. Complete removal of building and underlying contaminated soils with off-site disposal.
3. Partial removal of foundation and underlying contaminated soils with off-site disposal.
4. Modification of building for use as an on-site containment structure for storage of contaminated soils and sediments.

The recommended alternative for soil and sewer sediments is excavation and off-site disposal in a licensed hazardous waste facility. The recommended alternative for the building and underlying soil is partial removal of flooring and contaminated soil and off-site disposal in a licensed hazardous waste facility. A final decision on which alternatives to implement will be made by U.S. EPA headquarters after consideration of all public opinions and concerns regarding the available alternatives.

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Need for Further Groundwater Study

Due to the complexity of the hydrogeology, the limited information available on groundwater flow, and the presence of other sources of groundwater contamination in the area, it was concluded that further study was needed to more adequately identify the extent and nature of the groundwater contamination problem at Northernnaire Plating. The Department of Natural Resources has requested a supplemental grant of \$244,162 from U.S. EPA to fund further groundwater studies.

In conjunction with the further investigation of Northernnaire Plating groundwater contamination, the overall Cadillac area groundwater contamination problem is being addressed under Michigan's Environmental Response Act (Act 307). Approximately \$1.3 million has been allocated for work on the Cadillac area groundwater problem, of which \$872,000 is designated for water supply extensions to affected parties in Haring Township and within city limits. The remainder (approximately \$445,000) is to be used for investigatory work. E.C. Jordan Co. will be working on the overall Cadillac area groundwater contamination investigation as well as continuing with Northernnaire to maintain as much coordination of the two projects as possible. The Cadillac area work plan, which outlines investigation activities addressing the regional groundwater contamination problem, has been submitted by the E.C. Jordan Co. to the DNR for review.

If you have any questions regarding the site investigation or Feasibility Study, contact Mr. Gary Simons at the address shown on the front page of this report.